

16,817 of profit over a year. Seems too good to be true? Well, these calculations are based on the current difficulty rate and as time goes by this will increase and you will find it more difficult to mine. That means that the returns reduce significantly. Moreover, they haven't started the service yet which means by the time they do open their doors to the general public the profitability goes down even further. Since there is no clear release timeline at the moment we can't calculate the estimate for breaking even your initial investment.

There are plenty of tools available online to help you get estimates on your hardware. Check out <http://www.bitcoinx.com/profit/> for a well thought out calculator.

Software for mining

The hardware is just one part of bitcoin mining. You need to worry about the software as well. There are quite a few software but we'll mention the more popular ones that are widely supported.

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|-------------|----------------|
| 1. BFG | 2. BitMiner |
| 3. BTCMiner | 4. cgminer |
| 5. Diablo | 6. EasyMiner |
| 7. gMiner | 8. GroupFabric |
| 9. MPBM | 10. Phoenix |
| 11. poclbm | |

Not all of them support GPUs and ASIC and lastly, FPGA mining. One that does all three is cgminer, however, it may be a bit difficult for beginners to fiddle with since there is a fair bit of tweaking involved in getting it to work. We don't know if you've noticed but the GPU lists in the previous section did not feature recent GPUs, that is because the high end GPUs have undergone a slight architectural change and it will be a short while before these software start working on those GPUs.

If you are going to be using ASIC or FPGA then you need to figure out which software out of these is supported by your hardware. As for those you wish to mine on their computers, cgminer should be more than sufficient.

Join a pool

If the numbers weren't convincing enough then we're letting you know that solo mining is as good as dead. You need to join a pool in order to actually get something out of all the effort you're going to be putting in. There